

**This Patient Group Direction (PGD) is intended only for registered healthcare professionals who have been named and authorised by their organisation to practice under it.**

Patient Group Direction  
for the administration of Pneumovax 23 or Prevenar 13 to vaccinate against Pneumococcal Disease

## Summary of NICE / NICE CKS Guidelines for Pneumococcal Vaccination

### Overview

- Pneumococcal disease is caused by *Streptococcus pneumoniae*, leading to infections such as **pneumonia, septicaemia, and meningitis**.
- Vaccination is aimed at **preventing invasive pneumococcal disease (IPD)**, especially in high-risk groups.

## Types of Pneumococcal Vaccines Used in the UK

1. **PCV15 or PCV13** (Prevenar 15 / 13):
  - **Conjugate vaccines** — used in infants and selected high-risk groups.
2. **PPSV23** (Pneumovax 23):
  - **Polysaccharide vaccine** — protects against 23 serotypes.
  - Used in adults and older children at risk of IPD.

## Routine Childhood Schedule (UK)

- **PCV15 (or PCV13)** is given as:
  - **First dose at 12 weeks**
  - **Booster at 1 year** (as part of routine infant immunisation)

Note: The exact schedule may vary based on updated UKHSA recommendations.

## At-Risk Groups (Eligible for Additional Vaccination)

Offer **PPSV23** (or PCV plus PPSV23) to individuals aged **2 years and over** with:

- **Chronic respiratory, heart, kidney, liver or neurological conditions**

- **Diabetes**
- **Immunosuppression** (e.g. HIV, chemotherapy, asplenia)
- **Cochlear implants**
- **CSF leaks**
- **Sickle cell disease or other haemoglobinopathies**

High-risk children under 2 years may receive **additional PCV doses** on a tailored schedule.

## Older Adults

- **All adults aged 65 years** are offered a **single dose of PPSV23**, unless already vaccinated.

## Vaccination Schedule by Risk Group (Simplified)

| Group                      | Vaccine                                             | Notes                               |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Infants                    | <b>PCV15/13</b> at 12 weeks + booster at 1 year     | Routine                             |
| Adults ≥65                 | <b>PPSV23</b> (one-off)                             | Even if healthy                     |
| At-risk ≥2 years           | <b>PPSV23</b>                                       | May also need PCV if never received |
| Severely immunocompromised | <b>PCV</b> followed by <b>PPSV23</b> after ≥8 weeks | Requires specialist input           |

## Contraindications

- Severe allergic reaction to previous dose or vaccine component.
- Acute febrile illness (defer until recovery).

## Side Effects

- Mild: redness, swelling, pain at injection site; low-grade fever
- Rare: allergic reaction

## Co-Administration

- Can be given with other vaccines (e.g. flu, COVID-19), in a different limb or site.

## Documentation

- Record **vaccine name, batch number, site, date, and route.**
- Report adverse reactions via the **Yellow Card Scheme.**

# Patient Group Direction

for the supply/administration of

**Pneumovax 23**

for vaccination against

**Pneumococcal Disease**

## ***Healthcare professionals covered and training***

|                                       | Healthcare professionals allowed to work under this PGD and requirements                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Qualifications and Registration       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>● Pharmacist registered and practicing with the GPhC</li> <li>● Pharmacy technician registered and practicing with the GPhC</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Training and assessment               | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>● Pharmacists and Pharmacy Technicians must have completed training relevant to this condition to use this PGD. This training will be documented and overseen by the Get Real Health team.</li> <li>● All users must be familiar with the SPC for the products as well as BNF advice and any applicable national guidelines</li> <li>● All users must previously have used PGD's to supply medication</li> <li>● Must work in compliance with the SOPs of their own employer</li> <li>● All users must have appropriate indemnity in place to cover this service</li> </ul> |
| Further training and responsibilities | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>● All users must be up to date with CPD requirements and appraisal</li> <li>● All users must be up to date with MHRA and safety alerts with regards to medical products</li> <li>● All users must understand the concepts of capacity and consent and be aware of the Mental Capacity Act 2005.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |

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|------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PGD Indication                                       | Pneumovax 23 is indicated for active immunisation against pneumococcal disease caused by the 23 serotypes included in the vaccine for individuals aged 2 years and over at increased risk, in accordance with national guidance.                                                                                          |
| Inclusion criteria                                   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Individuals aged 2 years and over eligible for pneumococcal vaccination under national guidance.</li> <li>- Informed consent obtained from the individual or guardian.</li> <li>- No contraindications to pneumococcal vaccination.</li> </ul>                                   |
| Exclusion criteria                                   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Known hypersensitivity to Pneumovax 23 or any of its components.</li> <li>- Previous severe allergic reaction to any pneumococcal vaccine.</li> <li>- Acute illness with fever (postpone until recovered).</li> </ul>                                                            |
| Cautions                                             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Use with caution in individuals with bleeding disorders.</li> <li>- Record batch number and site of administration.</li> <li>- Monitor for anaphylaxis for 15 minutes after administration.</li> <li>- Inform patient of possible side effects and when to seek help.</li> </ul> |
| Actions if patient is excluded or declines treatment | Advise on alternative treatment options and how these can be accessed. Document any advice given and the decision reached. Inform or refer to the GP as appropriate                                                                                                                                                       |

### *Details of the medicine*

|                                             |                                                                                                            |
|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Name, form and strength of medicine         | Pneumovax 23                                                                                               |
| Legal category                              | POM                                                                                                        |
| Storage                                     | Store in a refrigerator (2°C–8°C). Do not freeze. Protect from light.                                      |
| Route/method of administration              | Intramuscular or subcutaneous injection.                                                                   |
| Dose and frequency                          | Single 0.5 mL dose. Revaccination may be considered after 5 years in high-risk individuals.                |
| Quantity to be administered and/or supplied | 0.5 mL per dose.                                                                                           |
| Maximum or minimum treatment period         | One lifetime dose in most cases. Repeat only under specific clinical recommendations.                      |
| Adverse effects                             | Injection site pain, redness, swelling, fever, fatigue, headache. Rare: allergic reactions. Refer to SmPC. |

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| Yellow card reporting | Report suspected adverse effects via <a href="https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk">https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk</a> and inform the GP as appropriate.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Records to be kept    | <p>Record the following information:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>● that valid informed consent was given</li> <li>● name of individual, address, date of birth and GP</li> <li>● name of healthcare practitioner</li> <li>● name and brand of medication</li> <li>● date of supply dose, form and route quantity supplied</li> <li>● advice given, including advice given if excluded or declines treatment</li> <li>● details of any adverse drug reactions and actions taken supplied via PGD</li> </ul> <p>Records should be signed and dated. All records should be clear, legible and contemporaneous. Electronic records can be made.</p> <p>A record of all individuals receiving treatment under this PGD should also be kept for audit purposes as follows:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>● Adults aged 18 years and over - keep records for 8 years</li> <li>● Children aged under 18 years -keep records until the 25<sup>th</sup> birthday (if the patient was 17 years when treatment was finished, keep records until the 26<sup>th</sup> birthday)</li> </ul> |

## Patient information

|                                                     |                                                                                                                                           |
|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Written information to be given to patient or carer | Supply the patient information leaflet (PIL) provided with the medication.                                                                |
| Follow-up advice to be given to patient or carer    | To seek medical advice if symptoms worsen rapidly or significantly, do not improve in 3–4 weeks, or they become systemically very unwell. |

## Key references

- NICE Medicines Practice Guideline 2 (MPG2): Patient Group Directions. Published March 2017 <https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mpg2>
- NICE MPG2 Patient group directions: competency framework for health professionals using patient group directions. Updated March 2017 <https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mpg2/resources>
- NICE CKS Guidance
- British National Formulary (BNF) Key information on the selection, prescribing, dispensing and administration of medicines [BNF \(British National Formulary\) | NICE](#)
- Summary of Product Characteristics

## Agreement to practise by the Registered Healthcare Professional

By signing this PGD you are confirming that you agree to its contents and that you will work within it. PGDs do not remove inherent professional obligations or accountability. It is the responsibility of each healthcare professional to practise only within the bounds of their own competence and professional code of conduct.

Name and address of pharmacy premises / clinic premises to which this PGD relates

| Name of healthcare professional | Job title | Registration number | Signature |
|---------------------------------|-----------|---------------------|-----------|
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| Valid from date                 |           | Expiry date         |           |
|                                 |           |                     |           |

**PGD adoption and authorisation by the employer/clinical lead**

The employer has ensured that the person using this PGD, has the knowledge and skills to safely provide the service which will encompass the supply or administration of a medication or medicine.

This section must be signed by the superintendent or clinical lead responsible for this service.

| Name of superintendent / clinical lead | Job title & name of organisation | Signature | Date |
|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------|------|
|                                        |                                  |           |      |

|                                      |                                  |           |      |
|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------|------|
| Name of professional group signatory | Job title & name of organisation | Signature | Date |
|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------|------|



### Signed on behalf of Get Real Health

| Name             | Qualification                  | Signature                                                                          | Date       |
|------------------|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| Nitin Shori      | Medical Doctor<br>GMC: 6047293 |  | 25/08/2025 |
| Chris Pilkington | Pharmacist<br>GPhC: 2046322    |  | 25/08/2025 |

### Change history

| Version number | Change details                 | Date                       |
|----------------|--------------------------------|----------------------------|
| 001            | Development & issue of new PGD | 25 <sup>th</sup> June 2025 |
|                |                                |                            |
|                |                                |                            |
|                |                                |                            |

# Patient Group Direction

for the supply/administration of

**Prevenar 13**

for vaccination against

**Pneumococcal Disease**

## ***Healthcare professionals covered and training***

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| Qualifications and Registration       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>● Pharmacist registered and practicing with the GPhC</li> <li>● Pharmacy technician registered and practicing with the GPhC</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
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|                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PGD Indication                                       | Prevenar 13 is indicated for active immunisation against pneumococcal disease caused by the 13 serotypes included in the vaccine, for infants, children, and adults in accordance with the national immunisation programme and clinical risk group recommendations.                                                         |
| Inclusion criteria                                   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Individuals eligible for pneumococcal vaccination under national childhood or adult immunisation programmes.</li> <li>- Informed consent obtained from individual or guardian.</li> <li>- No contraindications to Prevenar 13.</li> </ul>                                          |
| Exclusion criteria                                   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Known hypersensitivity to the active substance or any component of the vaccine.</li> <li>- Severe allergic reaction to a previous pneumococcal conjugate vaccine.</li> <li>- Acute febrile illness (postpone vaccination until recovery).</li> </ul>                               |
| Cautions                                             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Observe the patient for 15 minutes post-vaccination.</li> <li>- Use with caution in patients with bleeding disorders.</li> <li>- Record batch number and expiry date in the patient record.</li> <li>- Advise on expected side effects and when to seek medical advice.</li> </ul> |
| Actions if patient is excluded or declines treatment | Advise on alternative treatment options and how these can be accessed. Document any advice given and the decision reached. Inform or refer to the GP as appropriate                                                                                                                                                         |

### *Details of the medicine*

|                                             |                                                                                                                                      |
|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Name, form and strength of medicine         | Prevenar 13                                                                                                                          |
| Legal category                              | POM                                                                                                                                  |
| Storage                                     | Store in a refrigerator (2°C–8°C). Do not freeze. Protect from light.                                                                |
| Route/method of administration              | Intramuscular injection.                                                                                                             |
| Dose and frequency                          | 0.5 mL per dose according to the national immunisation schedule.                                                                     |
| Quantity to be administered and/or supplied | 0.5 mL per dose.                                                                                                                     |
| Maximum or minimum treatment period         | As per national immunisation schedule, including primary and booster doses.                                                          |
| Adverse effects                             | Irritability, drowsiness, loss of appetite, fever, injection site redness/swelling. Rare: hypersensitivity reactions. Refer to SmPC. |

|                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
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|                                      |                                  |           |      |
|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------|------|
| Name of professional group signatory | Job title & name of organisation | Signature | Date |
|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------|------|

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| Name             | Qualification                  | Signature                                                                          | Date       |
|------------------|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| Nitin Shori      | Medical Doctor<br>GMC: 6047293 |  | 25/08/2025 |
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